

Sexual Assault

History

- When did assault occur?
- Is assailant on scene or nearby? Has assailant been apprehended by law enforcement?
- Were any weapons or foreign bodies used?
- Was the victim under the influence of mind-altering substances? Were mind-altering substances forced onto victim or given to victim unknowingly?
- Has the patient changed clothing or underclothing since the assault?
- Has the victim showered or douched since the assault?
- Does the victim have any medical problems?
- Does the victim take any medications?
- Last menstrual period for females?

Physical

- General appearance – Acute distress? Life-threatening trauma or hemorrhage?
- Vital signs
- Mental status – Altered?
- Skin – Bruises? Burns? Lacerations? Hematomas? Contusions or abrasions?
- Obvious fractures?
- Other trauma?

Phone Numbers:

Key Concepts

- All injuries must be addressed before law enforcement interview or forensic exam
- Has patient changed clothing? If so, transport clothes with patient in a paper bag or wrapped in patient's own uninvolved clothing (if no paper bag available) for transport

EMT/AEMT

- Follow Trauma General Patient Care Guideline
- Treat all patients with respect and maintain privacy
- Complete primary and secondary assessment
- Gather most basic information and assess for life/ limb threatening injuries
- Notify Law Enforcement
- Ensure original clothing, shoes and undergarments are retained for LEO or transport with patient

Paramedic

- Assess BLS interventions
- If Trauma Triage Criteria are present then these override sexual assault destination protocol and transport to appropriate Trauma Center
- Document all interactions and assessments as they may be used in court
- Provide reassurance
- Pain management per Pain Management Guideline